

Anthem standard preapproval requirements

Georgia | Anthem Blue Cross and Blue Shield | Commercial

January 1, 2026

Certain items and/or criteria referenced in this document apply to local fully insured Anthem members in Georgia and select members who are covered under self-insured (ASO) benefit plans with services medically managed as part of a purchased program. It does not apply to BlueCard®, Medicare Advantage, Medicaid, Medicare Supplement, or Federal Employee Program® (FEP®). The provider will be notified upon requesting precertification if precertification is required for the member. If the program has not been purchased, precertification is not required and will not be performed for the member. For more information, please contact the phone number on the back of the member ID card.

Eligibility and benefits

Eligibility and benefits can be verified by accessing Anthem's website or by calling the number on the back of the member's identification card. Service preapproval is based on the member's benefit plan/eligibility at the time the service is reviewed/approved. Benefit plans vary widely and are subject to change based on the contract's effective dates. The provider is responsible for verification of member eligibility and covered benefits. Except in the case of an emergency, failure to obtain preapproval prior to rendering the designated services listed below will result in denial of reimbursement.

Note: NOC/Unlisted codes may be reviewed upon claim submission, depending on diagnosis and reimbursement level.

Carelon Medical Benefits Management

Carelon Medical Benefits Management, a separate company, is a nationally recognized leader delivering specialty benefits management on behalf of GA for certain health plan members. Determine if preapproval is needed for a GA member by clicking the "Medical Policy, Clinical UM Guidelines, and Preapproval Requirements" link on our provider website, or by calling the preapproval phone number printed on the back of the member's ID card. To submit your request for any of the services below, contact Carelon Medical Benefits

Carelon Medical Benefits Management, Inc. is a separate company providing utilization review services on behalf of the health plan.

Anthem Blue Cross and Blue Shield is the trade name of Blue Cross Blue Shield Healthcare Plan of Georgia, Inc. Independent licensee of the Blue Cross Blue Shield Association. Anthem is a registered trademark of Anthem Insurance Companies, Inc.

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Management online via Carelon Medical Benefits Management's provider portal at [Carelon Medical Benefits Management](#). From the drop-down menu, select **GA**. You may also call Carelon Medical Benefits Management at **866-714-1103**, Monday to Friday, 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. ET.

Carelon Medical Benefits Management provides benefits management for the programs listed below:

- > Advanced Imaging
- > Bariatrics
- > Base Surgical
- > Cancer Care Quality Program
- > Cardiovascular Services
- > Certain Outpatient Utilization Management Services
- > Diagnostic Imaging Management
- > Fertility
- > Genetic Testing
- > Imaging Level of Care
- > Musculoskeletal (MSK) Program
- > Oncology Drugs
- > Outpatient Sleep Testing and Therapy Services
- > Rehabilitative Services
- > Radiation Therapy Services
- > Sleep Therapy
- > Upper Gastrointestinal Endoscopy in Adults, and Site of Care for Certain Surgical Services
- > Vascular Services

For more details on these programs, please visit the Carelon Medical Benefits Management site at [Carelon Medical Benefits Management](#).

By selecting the link above, you will be linked to sites created and/or maintained by another, separate entity ("External Site"). Upon linking, you are subject to the terms of use, privacy, copyright, and security policies of the External Sites. We provide these links solely for your information and convenience. We encourage you to review the privacy practices of the External Sites. The information contained on the External Sites should not be interpreted as medical advice or treatment provided by us.

Institutional admissions requiring preapproval

- Acute inpatient (Including transplants)

- Out-of-network/out-of-area non-emergency services (HMO/POS/Blue Direct HMO and Blue Open Access Only)

• Sub-acute inpatient – Long Term Care • Skilled Nursing • Inpatient rehabilitation Note: For urgent/emergent admissions, all facilities must notify Anthem within 24 hours or the next business day.	• Mental health and substance use services, including Residential Treatment 800-292-2879 or fax 866-737-8503
Outpatient and some inpatient services requiring preapproval	
Ablative Techniques as a Treatment for Barrett’s Esophagus Activity Therapy for Autism Spectrum Disorders and Rett Syndrome Adaptive Behavioral Treatment Advanced Lipoprotein Testing Algorithmic Tests for Liver Fibrosis Allogeneic Bone Marrow-Derived Mesenchymal Stromal Cell Therapy Allogeneic, Xenographic, Synthetic, Bioengineered, and Composite Products for Wound Healing and Soft Tissue Grafting Altered Auditory Feedback Devices for Fluency Disorders Ambulance Services: Air and Water Analysis of Urine Biomarkers for Chronic Pain Management Anesthesia Services for Interventional Pain Management Procedures Aortic Aneurysm, Thoracic, Repair with Graft Aortic Coarctation, Excision or Repair AR Robotic Arm Assistive Devices Artificial Anal Sphincter for the Treatment of Severe Fecal Incontinence Artificial Intelligence-Based Software for Prostate Cancer Detection Artificial Retinal Devices Autologous Adipose-derived Regenerative Cell Therapy Autologous Cell Sheet-Based Gene Therapy for Treatment of Dystrophic Epidermolysis Bullosa Autologous Fat Grafting and Injectable Soft Tissue Fillers Automated Evacuation of Meibomian Gland Automated Nerve Conduction Testing Autonomic Testing Axial Lumbar Interbody Fusion Balloon Dilation of the Eustachian Tubes Balloon Sinus Ostial Dilation Bariatric Surgery and Other Treatments for Clinically Severe Obesity	

Blepharoplasty, Blepharoptosis Repair, and Brow Lift
Blood-based Biomarker Tests for Multiple Sclerosis
Bone-Anchored and Bone Conduction Hearing Aids
Brain Computer Interface Rehabilitation Devices
Breast Ductal Examination and Fluid Cytology Analysis
Breast Procedures, including Reconstructive Surgery, Implants, and Other Breast Procedures
Bronchial Thermoplasty
Canaloplasty
Cardiac Contractility Modulation Therapy
Cardiac Electrophysiological Studies (EPS) and Catheter Ablation
Cardiac Valve Replacement or Repair
Cardiac Valve: Ross Procedure Cardioverter-Defibrillators
Carotid Sinus Baroreceptor Stimulation Devices
Carotid, Vertebral, and Intracranial Artery Angioplasty with or without Stent Placement
Cellular Therapy Products for Allogeneic Stem Cell Transplantation
Cervical and Thoracic Discography
Circulating Tumor DNA Panel Testing (Liquid Biopsy)
Coblation® Therapies for Musculoskeletal Conditions
Cochlear Implants and Auditory Brainstem Implants
Combined Pathogen Identification and Drug Resistance Testing
Compression Devices for Lymphedema
Continuous Monitoring of Intraocular Pressure
Convection-Enhanced Delivery of Therapeutic Agents to the Brain
Cooling Devices and Combined Cooling/Heating Devices
Corneal Collagen Cross-Linking
Cosmetic and Reconstructive Services of the Head and Neck
Cosmetic and Reconstructive Services of the Trunk, Groin, and Extremities
Cosmetic and Reconstructive Services: Skin Related
Cryoablation for Plantar Fasciitis and Plantar Fibroma
Cryopreservation of Oocytes or Ovarian Tissue
Cryosurgery of Peripheral Nerves
Cryosurgical, Radiofrequency, Microwave, or Laser Ablation to Treat Solid Tumors Outside the Liver
Cryosurgical, Radiofrequency, Microwave, or Percutaneous Ethanol Ablation to Treat Solid Tumors in the Liver
Custodial Care
Deep Brain, Cortical, and Cerebellar Stimulation
Detection of Circulating Tumor Cells

Diaphragmatic/Phrenic Nerve Stimulation and Diaphragm Pacing Systems
Doppler-Guided Transanal Hemorrhoidal Dearterialization
Drug-Eluting Devices for Maintaining Sinus Ostial Patency
Durable Medical Equipment (DME)
Dynamic Spinal Visualization (Including Digital Motion X-ray and Cineradiography/
Videofluoroscopy)
Electrical Impedance Scanning for Cancer Detection
Electrical Stimulation as a Treatment for Pain and Other Conditions: Surface and
Percutaneous Devices
Electroencephalography and Video Electroencephalographic Monitoring
Electronic Home Visual Field Monitoring
Electrophysiology-Guided Noninvasive Stereotactic Cardiac Radioablation
Electrothermal Shrinkage of Joint Capsules, Ligaments, and Tendons
Encapsulated Cell Therapy for Degenerative Ocular Disease
Epiduroscopy
External Upper Limb Stimulation for the Treatment of Tremors
Extracorporeal Carbon Dioxide Removal
Extracorporeal Shock Wave Therapy
Extraosseous Subtalar Joint Implantation and Subtalar Arthroereisis
Eye Movement Analysis Using Non-spatial Calibration for the Diagnosis of Concussion
Fecal Analysis Panels in the Diagnosis of Intestinal Disorders
Focal Laser Ablation for the Treatment of Prostate Cancer
Functional Electrical Stimulation (FES); Threshold Electrical Stimulation (TES)
Functional Endoscopic Sinus Surgery (FESS)
Gait Modulation Systems Using Rhythmic Auditory Stimulation
Gallbladder Removal
Gene Therapy
Genicular Procedures for Treatment of Knee Pain
Hepzato Kit™ (Melphalan Hepatic Delivery System)
High-volume Colonic Irrigation
Histotripsy
Home Parenteral Nutrition
Home Video-Assisted Robotic Rehabilitation Systems
Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy (Systemic/Topical)
Hyperoxemic Reperfusion Therapy
Hysterectomy
Idiopathic Environmental Illness (IEI)
Immune Cell Function Assay
Implantable Ambulatory Event Monitors and Mobile Cardiac Telemetry

Implantable Infusion Pumps
Implantable Left Atrial Hemodynamic Monitor
Implantable Middle Ear Hearing Aids
Implantable Peripheral Nerve Stimulation Devices as a Treatment for Pain
Implantable Shock Absorber for Treatment of Knee Osteoarthritis
Implantation of Occipital, Supraorbital or Trigeminal Nerve Stimulation Devices (and Related Procedures)
Implanted Artificial Iris Devices
Implanted Devices for Spinal Stenosis
Implanted Port Delivery Systems to Treat Ocular Disease
In Vitro Chemosensitivity Assays and In Vitro Chemoresistance Assays
Ingestible Devices for the Treatment of Constipation
Ingestion Event Monitors
Inhaled Nitric Oxide
Inpatient Interfacility Transfers
Intensive In-home Behavioral Health Services
Intermittent Abdominal Pressure Ventilation Devices
Internal Rib Fixation Systems
Interspinous Process Fixation Devices
Intervertebral Stabilization Devices
Intracardiac Ischemia Monitoring
Intracytoplasmic Sperm Injection (ICSI)
Intradialytic Parenteral Nutrition
Intraocular Anterior Segment Aqueous Drainage Devices (without extraocular reservoir)
Intraocular Telescope
Intraoperative Assessment of Surgical Margins During Breast-Conserving Surgery with Radiofrequency Spectroscopy or Optical Coherence Tomography
Intrapulmonary Percussive Ventilation Devices
Intussusception Reduction, Surgical Kidney Transplantation
Irreversible Electroporation
Laser Treatment of Onychomycosis
Lower Esophageal Sphincter Augmentation Devices
Lower Esophageal Sphincter Augmentation Devices for the Treatment of Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)
Low-Frequency Ultrasound Therapy for Wound Management
Lumbar Discography
Lysis of Epidural Adhesions
Machine Learning Derived Probability Score for Rapid Kidney Function Decline
Magnetic Resonance Neurography

Magnetic Source Imaging and Magnetoencephalography
Mandibular/Maxillary (Orthognathic) Surgery
Manipulation Under Anesthesia
Mastectomy for Gynecomastia
Mechanical Circulatory Assist Devices (Ventricular Assist Devices, Percutaneous Ventricular Assist Devices, and Artificial Hearts)
Mechanized Spinal Distraction Therapy
Medical Specialty Drug Reviews (non-oncology)
Metagenomic Sequencing for Infectious Diseases in the Outpatient Setting
Microsurgical Procedures for the Prevention or Treatment of Lymphedema
Minimally Invasive Treatment of the Posterior Nasal Nerve to Treat Rhinitis
Moderate to Deep Anesthesia Services for Dental Surgery in the Facility Setting
Molecular Signature Test for Predicting Response to Tumor Necrosis Factor Inhibitor Therapy
MRI Guided High Intensity Focused Ultrasound Ablation for Non-Oncologic Indications
Multi-biomarker Disease Activity Blood Tests for Rheumatoid Arthritis
Multiplex Autoantigen Microarray Testing for Systemic Lupus Erythematosus
Myocardial Strain Imaging
Myocardial Sympathetic Innervation Imaging with or without Single-Photon Emission Computed Tomography (SPECT)
Nanoparticle-Mediated Thermal Ablation
Nasal Valve Repair
Near-Infrared Coronary Imaging and Near-Infrared Intravascular Ultrasound Coronary Imaging
Near-Infrared Spectroscopy Scanning for Brain Hematoma Screening
Neonatal Levels of Care
Non-invasive Heart Failure and Arrhythmia Management and Monitoring Systems
Noninvasive Imaging Technologies for the Evaluation of Skin Lesions
Non-Invasive Measurement of Left Ventricular End Diastolic Pressure in the Outpatient Setting
Occipital and Sphenopalatine Ganglion Nerve Block Therapy for the Treatment of Headache and Neuralgia
Optical Detection for Screening and Identification of Cervical Cancer
Oral, Pharyngeal and Maxillofacial Surgical Treatment for Obstructive Sleep Apnea or Snoring
Outpatient Cardiac Hemodynamic Monitoring Using a Wireless Sensor for Heart Failure Management
Outpatient Intravenous Insulin Therapy
Pain Management Biomarker Analysis

Panniculectomy and Abdominoplasty
Paraesophageal Hernia Repair
Parenteral Antibiotics for the Treatment of Lyme Disease
Patent Foramen Ovale and Left Atrial Appendage Closure Devices
Penile Prosthesis Implantation
Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAS) Testing
Percutaneous Spinal Surgery
Percutaneous Ultrasonic Ablation of Soft Tissue
Percutaneous Vertebral Disc Procedures
Peripheral Nerve Blocks for Treatment of Neuropathic Pain
PET/MRI
Physiologic Recording of Tremor using Accelerometer(s) and Gyroscope(s)
Pneumatic Compression Devices for Prevention of Deep Vein Thrombosis of the Extremities in the Home Setting
Pneumatic Pressure Devices
Portable Normothermic Organ Perfusion Systems
Powered Robotic Lower Body Exoskeleton Devices
Powered Wheeled Mobility Devices
Preimplantation Embryo Biopsy
Private Duty Nursing in the Home Setting
Products for Wound Healing and Soft Tissue Grafting: Investigational
Products for Wound Healing and Soft Tissue Grafting: Medically Necessary Uses
Protein Biomarkers for the Screening, Detection, and Management of Prostate Cancer
Quantitative Muscle Testing Devices
Quantitative Sensory Testing
Quantitative Ultrasound for Tissue Characterization
Radiofrequency and Pulsed Radiofrequency Treatment of Trigger Point Pain
Radiofrequency Neurolysis and Pulsed Radiofrequency Therapy for Trigeminal Neuralgia
Radiostereometric Analysis (RSA)
Reduction Mammoplasty
Rehabilitative Devices with Remote Monitoring
Remote Devices for Intermittent Monitoring of Intraocular Pressure
Renal Sympathetic Nerve Ablation
Rhinophototherapy
Rupture of Membranes Testing in Pregnancy
Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Retention, Urinary Incontinence, and Fecal Incontinence
Saliva-based Testing to Determine Drug-Metabolizer Status
Selected Blood, Serum and Cellular Allergy and Toxicity Tests

Selected Protein Biomarker Algorithmic Assays
Selected Sleep Testing Services
Selected Tests for the Evaluation and Management of Infertility
Self-Expanding Absorptive Sinus Ostial Dilation
Sensory Stimulation for Brain-Injured Individuals in Coma or Vegetative State
Septoplasty
Serologic Testing for Biomarkers of Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS)
Serological Antibody Testing For Helicobacter Pylori
Serum Biomarker Tests for Risk of Preeclampsia
Silver-based Products for Wound and Soft Tissue Applications
Site of Care: Specialty Pharmaceuticals
Skin Nerve Fiber Density Testing
Spectral Analysis of Prostate Tissue by Fluorescence Spectroscopy
Static Progressive Stretch (SPS) and Patient-Actuated Serial Stretch (PASS) Devices
Surface Electrical Stimulation Devices for Headache and Migraine
Surface Electromyography and Electrodermal Activity Sensor Devices for Seizure Monitoring
Surgical and Ablative Treatments for Chronic Headaches
Systems Pathology and Multimodal Artificial Intelligence Testing for Cancerous and Precancerous Conditions
Temporomandibular Disorders
Testing for Biochemical Markers for Alzheimer's Disease
Therapeutic Apheresis
Therapeutic use of Stem Cells, Blood, and Bone Marrow Products
Tibial Nerve Stimulation
Topographic Genotyping
Total Ankle Replacement
Transanal Radiofrequency Treatment of Fecal Incontinence
Transcatheter Heart Valve Procedures
Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation
Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation
Transendoscopic Therapy for Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease, Dysphagia, or Gastroparesis
Transmyocardial Revascularization
Transmyocardial/Periventricular Device Closure of Ventricular Septal Defects
Treatment of Varicose Veins (Lower Extremities)
Treatments for Urinary Incontinence
Ultrafiltration in Decompensated Heart Failure
Ultrasound Ablation for Oncologic Indications
Ultrasound Bone Growth Stimulation

Upper Extremity Myoelectric Orthoses
Upper Gastrointestinal Endoscopy in Adults
Use of 3-D, 4-D, or 5-D Ultrasound in Maternity Care
Uterine Fibroid Ablation: Laparoscopic, Percutaneous, or Transcervical Image Guided Techniques
Vagus Nerve Stimulation
Venous Angioplasty with or without Stent Placement or Venous Stenting Alone
Virtual Reality-Assisted Therapy Systems
Wearable Devices for Stress Relief and Management
Wireless Capsule for the Evaluation of Suspected Gastric and Intestinal Motility Disorders

Service coverage

HMO: Services listed above require preapproval and will be denied if rendered without the appropriate preapproval, regardless of whether rendered in or out-of- network. HMO members do not have benefits for non-emergency services rendered outside of the network without obtaining a preapproval.

POS: Services listed above require preapproval and will be denied if rendered without the appropriate preapproval, regardless of whether rendered in or out-of- network. Providers must have a referral for in-network benefit payment except for Blue Direct specialists and Open Access providers performing services that no longer require preapproval. If there is no referral or the member self-referred, the out-of-network benefit level will be paid.

PPO: Services listed above require preapproval and will be denied if rendered without the appropriate preapproval, regardless of whether rendered in or out-of- network. PPO members do not require a referral for benefit payment.

(Non-urgent) preapproval-notification process for Anthem:

- Submit all required clinical information 15 calendar days before the proposed procedure when possible. A minimum time frame of three (3) business days is required to complete a thorough clinical analysis. A preapproval number will be provided to you once all clinical information has been received and reviewed.
- Institutional admissions — All facilities must notify us within 24 hours or the next business day (whichever is earlier) after admission.